100 ORIGINAL STARTING POINTS

Your stories.
A stronger *first line.*

100 hook templates for professionals, freelancers, business owners and people ready to start sharing.

You don't need a dramatic life story. Begin with something you've noticed, learned, tried or changed your mind about.

Make the template yours

1. Choose a real experience or useful idea first.
2. Pick a first line that fits it. Replace every bracket with a specific detail.
3. Deliver what the opening promises. Remove anything you can't honestly support.

Original prompts by Ray Chua. These are creative starting points, not tested promises of views, clients or income. No fabricated stories, testimonials or results needed.

HOOKS 001–010

Get specific about the problem

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

001	You know [topic]. So why is [task] still so difficult?
002	[Task] keeps slipping to tomorrow. Which part are you avoiding?
003	If [problem] happens at [specific moment], check [factor].
004	Stuck between [option A] and [option B]? Start with your actual goal.
005	Your [output] looks finished. Does it answer [important question]?
006	Before you fix [visible problem], look at [possible cause].
007	What makes [task] difficult isn't always [obvious obstacle].
008	You've done [preparation]. The next step is [small action].
009	If [constraint] is getting in the way, shrink [task] to this.
010	[Frustration] doesn't tell you much until you check [context].

HOOKS 011–020

Leave one honest question open

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

011	I changed one detail in [work]. Can you spot it?
012	These two [outputs] look similar. They solve different problems.
013	There's a reason I left [detail] out of [work].
014	The useful part of [experience] happened after [unexpected moment].
015	[Result] surprised me. Here's what I checked next.
016	I nearly chose [option]. Then I noticed [specific detail].
017	This [ordinary object] explains how I think about [topic].
018	One sentence in [conversation] made me pause.
019	Why did I keep [imperfect detail] in the final [output]?
020	I expected [outcome]. The first clue was something else.

HOOKS 021–030

Offer a manageable next step

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

021	Got [small amount of time]? Use it to practise [specific action].
022	Before your next [task], write down [one useful thing].
023	You can practise [skill] with [ordinary resource] today.
024	For [specific situation], I'd begin with [action].
025	Try changing [one variable] before replacing your whole [process].
026	A simpler starting point for [task]: [small action].
027	Use [question] to choose your next [action].
028	You don't need to finish [large project] to try [small step].
029	If [approach] feels too much, keep just [essential part].
030	Here's a quick check before you [decision or action].

HOOKS 031–040

Make your perspective clear

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

031	I choose [priority] over [alternative] when [specific context].
032	[Advice] leaves out something important: [condition].
033	For [audience], [metric] isn't the only sign of progress.
034	I'm less interested in [surface feature] than [deeper quality].
035	[Method] can help. It can also get in the way when [condition].
036	I changed my position on [topic] because of [experience].
037	The distinction I care about: [concept A] versus [concept B].
038	My boundary with [practice] is [personal limit].
039	You can value [goal A] without giving up [goal B].
040	I judge [work] by [criterion], not just [common criterion].

HOOKS 041–050

Start inside a real moment

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

041	I was about to [action] when [specific interruption].
042	Halfway through [task], I realised [observation].
043	I remember looking at [detail] and thinking, "[honest thought]".
044	[Someone, anonymised] asked [question]. I didn't answer immediately.
045	The day I tried [activity], I brought [specific expectation].
046	I left [experience] with a different question than I arrived with.
047	At [place or moment], [ordinary detail] caught my attention.
048	I had [resource], [constraint] and one decision to make.
049	After [event], I went back to [familiar task] differently.
050	What stayed with me from [experience] wasn't [obvious highlight].

HOOKS 051–060

Show the work

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

051	Here's the rough version of [output]. Watch what I change.
052	I'm keeping [detail] and removing [detail]. Here's why.
053	Let's solve one small part of [task] together.
054	This is [process] before it looks polished.
055	Look at [specific detail] while I [demonstrate action].
056	I'll pause at the decision that matters in [process].
057	Here's the same [material] arranged in two different ways.
058	Before I use [tool], I decide [important input].
059	I'm working around [constraint]. This is my next move.
060	Watch how [one change] affects [visible feature].

HOOKS 061–070

Explain something people can use

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

061	[Term] becomes easier to understand when you compare it with [analogy].
062	To understand [concept], separate these two questions.
063	When [situation] happens, [signal] is worth noticing.
064	[Outcome] and [outcome] can look alike. Here's how I distinguish them.
065	This part of [process] is easier to show than describe.
066	If you remember one detail about [topic], make it [detail].
067	The answer to [question] changes when [condition] changes.
068	Here's what [concept] looks like outside a textbook.
069	Take [ordinary situation]. It's a useful way into [topic].
070	What does [technical term] mean for someone doing [real task]?

HOOKS 071–080

Build recognition without pressure

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

071	You can enjoy [activity] and still dread [part of it].
072	[Task] feels different when people you know might see it.
073	There's a gap between knowing [topic] and feeling ready to share it.
074	I'm learning to leave [imperfection] alone long enough to finish.
075	When I compare my [work] with [reference], I forget [missing context].
076	It's okay to keep [private detail] out of the story.
077	Being new at [skill] doesn't erase your experience in [other area].
078	I can make time for [small step], even when [bigger plan] won't fit.
079	If [feeling] shows up before [action], what would make the step smaller?
080	You don't need a dramatic story to share [useful observation].

HOOKS 081–090

Share progress with context

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

081	My [first version] and my [current version] show one change in how I think.
082	I tried [approach] for [actual period]. Here's what I observed.
083	I'm not finished with [project], but this part is clearer now.
084	[Attempt] didn't answer my question. It gave me a better one.
085	One part of [routine] is working for me; another needs adjusting.
086	I can now [specific action]. My next challenge is [next skill].
087	I expected progress to look like [assumption]. I noticed [different sign].
088	This update includes a win, a limitation and a next step.
089	I stopped measuring only [metric] and started noticing [other signal].
090	Here's the part of my [learning process] I'm still unsure about.

HOOKS 091–100

Invite the right conversation

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

091	If [task] keeps falling off your list, which part would you hand over?
092	Your [expertise or story] is the starting point. Here's how I help shape it.
093	Before we discuss [service], tell me what you want [work] to communicate.
094	Working together on [deliverable] starts with [simple input].
095	Here's what I handle in [service]—and what I'll need from you.
096	You might need [type of support], rather than another [resource].
097	If you want [realistic deliverable], here's what the process involves.
098	Not sure whether [service] fits? Ask me about [relevant scope question].
099	The first thing I want to understand about your [project] is [context].
100	If [specific challenge] sounds familiar, tell me where you're starting.

CHOOSE THE OPENING THAT FITS

Attention with a *purpose.*

A hook is an opening choice, not a magic sentence. Choose what helps the right person recognise the topic and want the next line.

Recognition
Name a specific situation the viewer knows. Follow with a useful explanation or a manageable next step.

Curiosity
Leave one relevant question open. Answer it in the content; don't hide a weak idea behind suspense.

Demonstration
Show a rough draft, an action or a meaningful comparison. Tell viewers what to notice.

Perspective
Make your position clear and explain your reasoning. Disagreement is optional; being useful matters more.

Specific beats inflated

"This fixes your content" promises too much. "Before recording, choose the one question this video answers" gives someone a concrete action.

These are editorial principles inferred from content patterns, not causal findings or a guarantee of reach.

ONE IDEA, DIFFERENT ENTRY POINTS

Give them a reason to *stay.*

Worked example: a freelancer wants to explain why clear project briefs matter. All three openings lead to the same useful lesson.

Recognition
"The deadline is clear. But do you and your client mean the same thing by finished?"

Curiosity
"I added one question to my project brief. It wasn't about the deadline."

Demonstration
"Here are two briefs for the same project. Look at what the second one makes explicit."

Then deliver

Show or explain the question: what must the finished work include? Discuss the agreed output, reviewer and revision scope. Use a hypothetical brief or permissioned material; don't invent a client result.

Try your own version

Topic: _____
Who needs it: _____
One useful point: _____
What the opening promises: _____
Where I deliver that promise: _____

FROM FIRST LINE TO FIRST POST

Keep it *honest.* Keep it useful.

Before you record

- Does this sound like something I would actually say?
- Can I fulfil the opening with one clear story, explanation or demonstration?
- Am I presenting personal experience as personal experience?
- Have I removed private details or obtained permission to share them?

Use the companion format guide to give your idea a shape. A strong opening introduces something worth hearing; it doesn't replace the substance.

Try a small batch. Notice which topics bring thoughtful replies and relevant conversations, not only views. Performance varies; no single hook works for everyone.

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